



o use any operating system, you don't have to necessarily install it – at least with Ubuntu! Ubuntu can be used directly from a USB

drive or a DVD. Just boot the computer with the media and you'll find a usable desktop right away. However, a lot of functionality in the 'live' mode is limited by the transfer speeds and space available on the USB drive. You can't store all the software on a USB stick. In case you're using a DVD or a CD as boot media, you're in a much restricted environment and won't be able to install new software. So although installation is not a requirement, it is certainly recommended as a method to enjoy your freedom to the fullest.

If you've got this far and are reading this very sentence, we believe you're already in a mood to pop in a Ubuntu disk and fire an installation. So let's get started. We'll show you the installation procedure for Ubuntu under different conditions.

Installing Ubuntu as a standalone OS

If you want to use Windows on your PC, you'll have to install it before Ubuntu. If you install Windows after Ubuntu, it will erase the bootloader created by Ubuntu. Although Ubuntu would still remain installed, it simply wouldn't be bootable! Windows doesn't add Ubuntu to its boot menu if it finds the Linux OS on the disk while being installed. Ubuntu, on the other